



THE BEST TIME TO BOOK A CRUISE

Travelholics Guide (Lowest → Mid Pricing)



QUICK NOTE

This guide focuses on WHEN TO BOOK.

Shoulder season refers to when you travel, which often affects pricing — that's why it's included.



30–90 DAYS BEFORE SAILING

(Last-Minute Booking Window)

What this is:

Cruise lines discount unsold cabins close to sail date.



PROS

Lowest potential pricing

Cruise lines motivated to fill cabins

Great for spontaneous travelers



CONS

Very limited cabin selection

Flights may be expensive or unavailable

Risky for families, groups, or special cabins

Best for: Locals, flexible schedules, repeat cruisers



SHOULDER SEASON

(Travel Timing That Impacts Price)

What is Shoulder Season?

The period between peak season and off-season when demand drops, crowds thin, and prices are often lower.

Typical Timing (varies by itinerary):

Late April – early June

September – early December (before holidays)

✅ PROS

Lower pricing due to reduced demand

Fewer kids and lighter crowds

Better chance for upgrades

⚠️ CONS

Weather can be unpredictable

Hurricane season overlap (Caribbean Aug–Oct)

Some ports or excursions may have limited hours

Travelholics Truth: This is value cruising — not bargain chasing.

💰 BLACK FRIDAY & CYBER MONDAY

(Perk-Focused Booking Window)

What this is:

Promotions that focus on extras rather than base fare.

✅ PROS

Bonus onboard credit

Drink packages, Wi-Fi, or dining perks

Great for stacking add-ons

⚠️ CONS

Base cruise price not always lower

Short booking windows

Offers can be confusing

Ready for More?

This guide covers the basics.



For packing lists, budgeting tips, and insider strategies:

Download the full Travelholics Cruise eBook.

Created by Travelholics.